

UX Report 1: Coursera

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Shortened User Experience Questionnaire

Obstructive	☐	☐	☐	☐	☒	☐	☐	Supportive
Complicated	☐	☐	☐	☐	☒	☐	☐	Easy
Inefficient	☐	☐	☐	☒	☐	☐	☐	Efficient
Confusing	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☒	☐	Clear
Boring	☐	☐	☐	☐	☒	☐	☐	Exciting
Not interesting	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☒	☐	Interesting
Conventional	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☒	☐	Inventive
Usual	☐	☐	☐	☐	☒	☐	☐	Leading edge

1. What was tested

One job was followed from start to finish: open a course, enrol, and begin the first lesson. The course used was Getting Started with Microsoft Copilot. Notes were kept on the moments that stood out, because the Peak-End Rule says people judge an experience by its strongest moment and by how it finished (Kahneman et al., 1993).

2. The course page

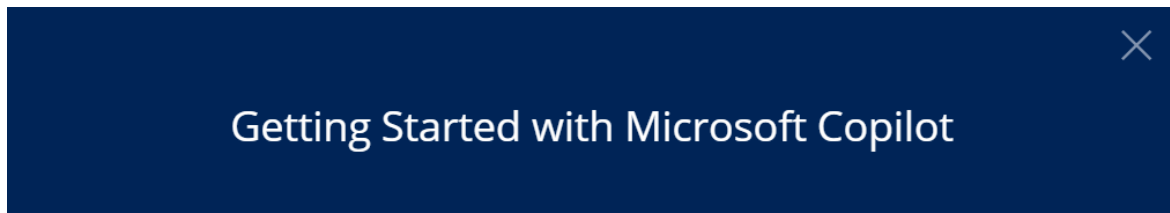


Figure 1: The course page. One blue button carries the whole screen.

A single blue button dominates the page. Enroll for free sits high on the left with nothing competing against it, and the line below, 14,883 already enrolled, gives a reason to trust the course before you commit. Four facts follow in a white strip: modules, rating, level and hours. Everything needed to decide is visible without scrolling.

3. Enrolling

Clicking the button does not open the lesson. Three pop-ups appear one after another. A notice about the certificate comes first, then a short welcome box, and then a commitment screen.



Full Course, No Certificate

You will still have access to all course materials for this course.

Continue

Figure 2: The first of three pop-ups, warning that the free option has no certificate.

My commitment

I'm beginning my learning in Getting Started with Microsoft Copilot

I know learning can be hard, but I have the patience, determination, and discipline to reach my goals.

When I'm stuck, I'll find a solution, like...

- Take a breath
- Break it down
- Ask for help
- Research
- Stay positive
- Talk through it

☒ I commit to completing this course

Start the course

Figure 3: The commitment screen, where the learner ticks a promise to finish.

Being asked to make a promise was the surprise of the session. Rather than confirming a purchase, Coursera asks the learner to commit, and it lists what to do when the work gets hard. People who agree to something in writing are more likely to follow through (Cialdini, 2007). A step that is usually dull becomes a moment worth remembering.

Learners who spend one hour learning on day 1 have an 80% higher success rate for course completion...

 Taking you to the first lesson within 5 seconds

Figure 4: Even the wait is used for encouragement.

The loading screen also does work. A spinner on its own would say nothing, so a statistic about learners who study on their first day fills the five seconds instead.

4. The first lesson

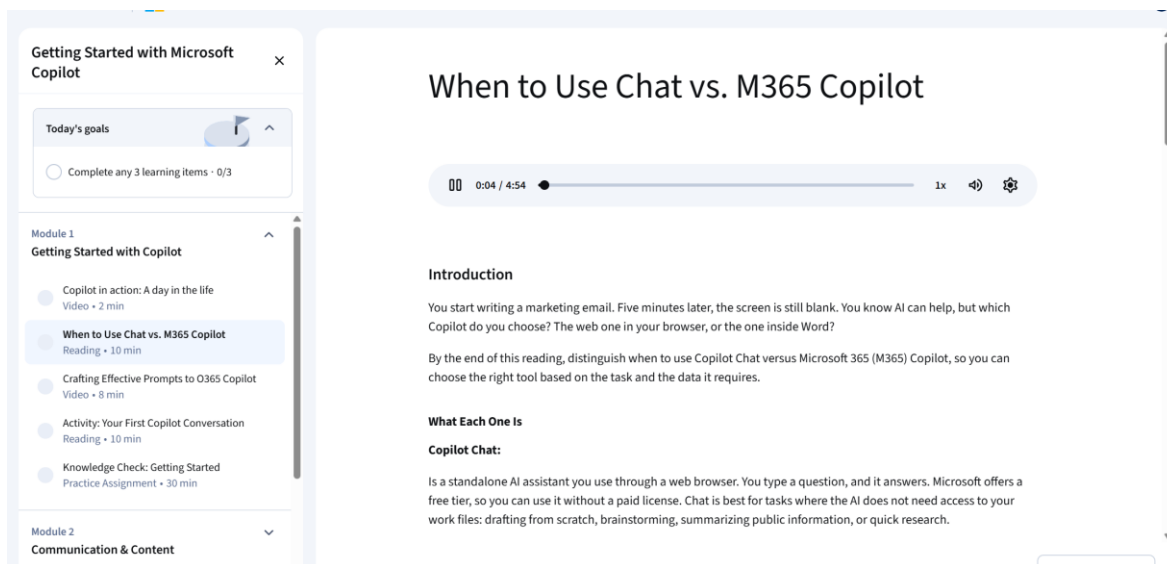


Figure 5: Today's goals sits above the module list, and Go to next item stays fixed in the corner.

Today's goals opens the sidebar and counts learning items, starting at 0 of 3. Each lesson carries an empty circle that fills once the item is done, so progress can be seen without leaving the page. Go to next item holds its position in the bottom right, which gives every lesson an obvious ending.

5. Peak and end

The commitment screen was the peak. Nothing else in the flow asked anything of the learner personally, so it stood apart. Endings are handled by the next-item button and the goals counter, and both push the learner on instead of letting a lesson trail off. Working against that, three pop-ups before the first lesson is a lot of clicking, and the certificate warning puts bad news exactly where excitement should be building.

6. Takeaways for SkillUP

- Give the course page one large primary action and keep other buttons away from it.
- Count what the learner has done today, and update the count as items are ticked.
- End a lesson with a clear next step rather than an empty screen.
- Use loading time for something encouraging.
- Keep confirmation to one step. Three in a row slows down the best part.
- Put bad news, such as what a free plan leaves out, before the button instead of after it.

References

Cialdini, R.B. (2007) *Influence: The Psychology of Persuasion*. Revised edn. New York: Collins.

Coursera (2026) *Getting Started with Microsoft Copilot*. Available at: <https://www.coursera.org> (Accessed: 22 September 2026).

Kahneman, D., Fredrickson, B.L., Schreiber, C.A. and Redelmeier, D.A. (1993) 'When more pain is preferred to less: adding a better end', *Psychological Science*, 4(6), pp. 401–405.

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